Configuring Salesforce API access: OAuth2 permissions for an App

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These instructions show how to configure access to a SalesForce instance using OAuth2 with PKCE to allow API access as the user who goes through the OAuth2 login process. The refresh token setting is limited to 8 hours of validity after last use.

1 Create an API Administrator

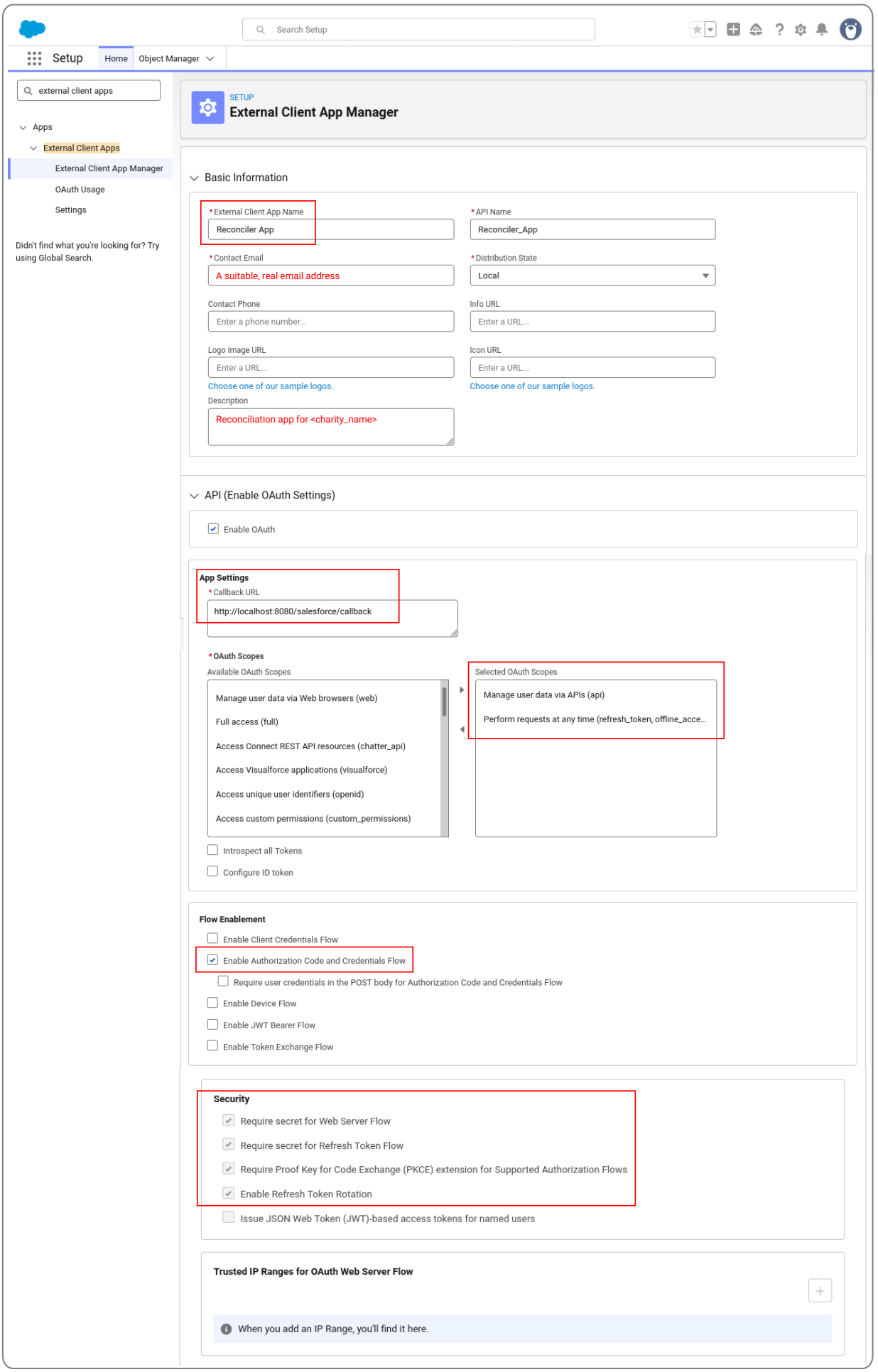
Make an API Administrator with a username like <api.admin@charity.org> (add "sandbox" at the end for the sandbox user). This should have a full salesforce licence and be assigned the System Administrator profile. This should have a monitored email address. (Note that the API Integration User mentioned in Salesforce docs is for a different use case.)

2 Check the System Administrator's profile has API access

Ensure the System Administrator profile has "API Enabled" turned on under Administrative Permissions.

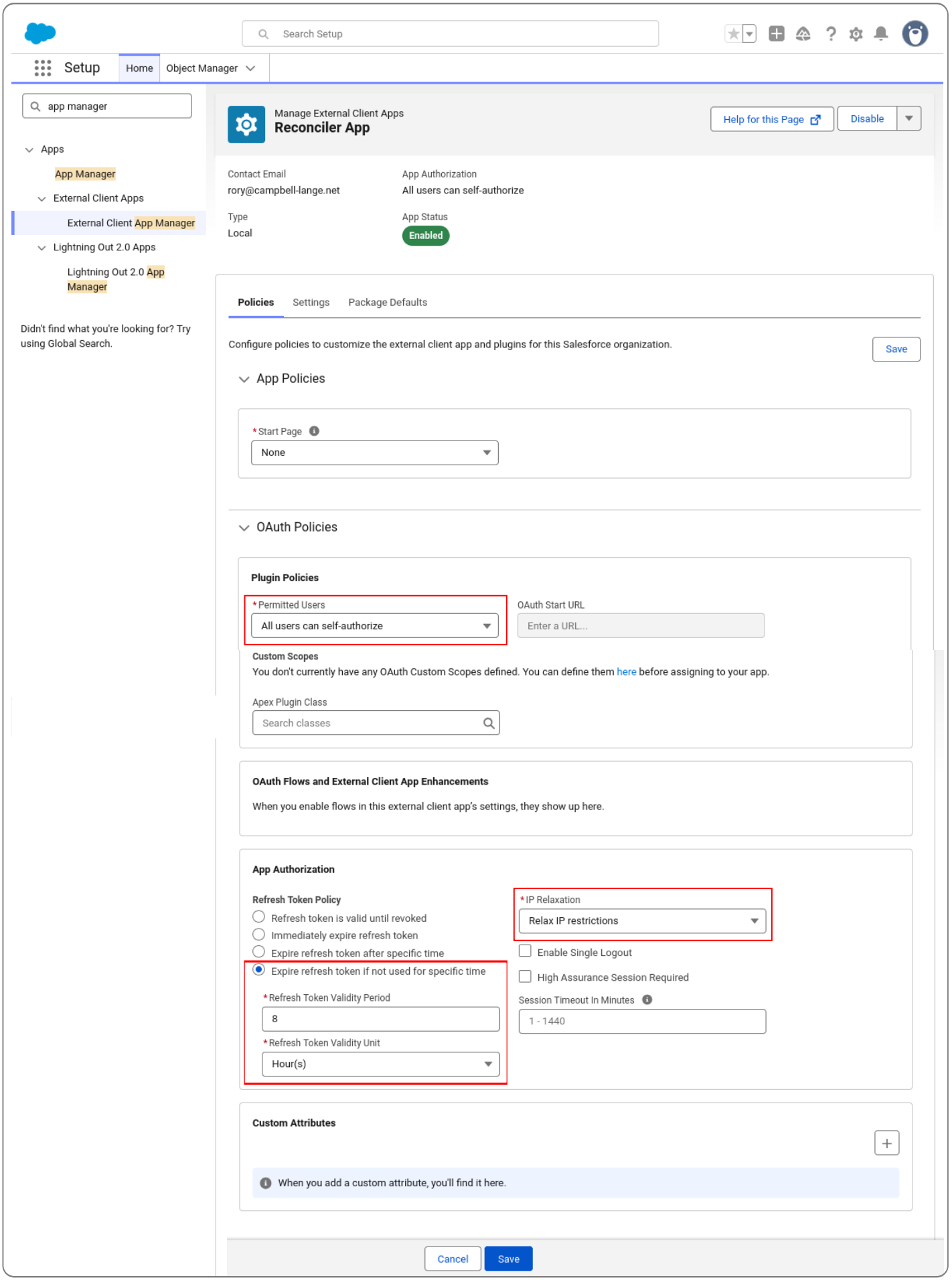
3 Define an "External App"

Log in as the API Administrator.
Under Settings > External Client App Manager choose to make a New External Client App.



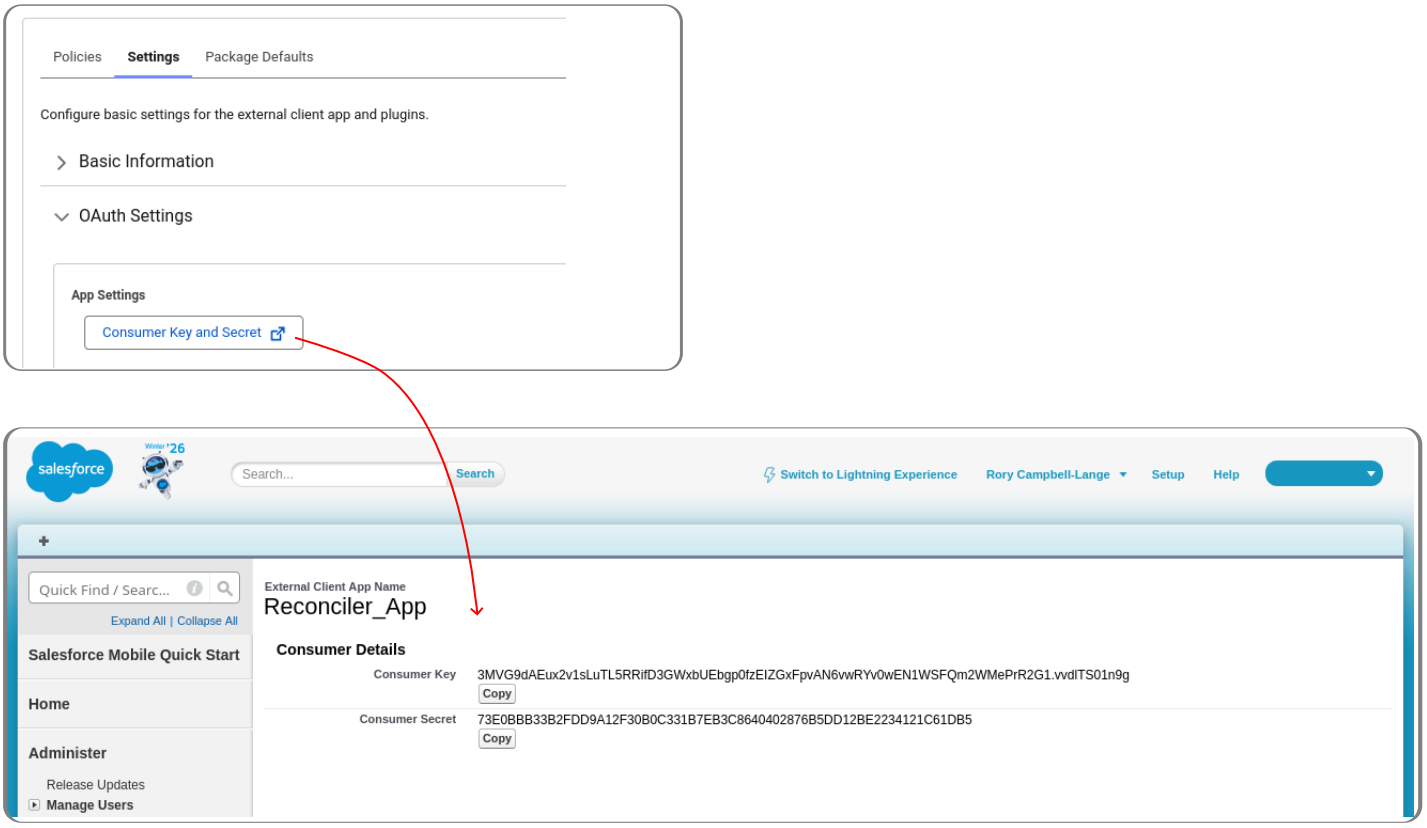
4 Define Policies

Save the initial settings and then move to the "Policies" tab.



5 Get the App Key & Secret

Save the Policies, then go back to Settings > OAuth Settings for the app and click the button to find the key and secret



6 Share App Key & Secret

Put the Key and Secret into a password protected file (e.g. Word or PDF) and send it to the App developer or user.

It is advisable to share the password via another channel, such as SMS.